



MONTHLY UPDATE

Uganda: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-06 · 30 systems and instruments tracked, 17 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-06 – July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

The month's largest single development was the close of an enforcement cycle rather than the opening of one. On 17 July 2026 the personal data protection office [confirmed by letter that a foreign controller had implemented all five corrective orders](#) from its February decision, within the prescribed timelines and with no appeal lodged. No fine was imposed.

Three regulatory campaigns opened alongside it – [nationwide enforcement against unlicensed public Wi-Fi from 7 July](#), a [national anti-piracy coordination effort on 17 July](#), and a ministerial statement of 31 July that [attacks on telecommunications infrastructure are treated as economic sabotage](#). Uganda also [took a seat on the African Telecommunications Union Administrative Council on 24 July](#).

The month closed with two announcements about instruments that do not yet exist: a policy to regulate artificial intelligence and social media, and a European Union funding window for a sovereign loan package on digital public infrastructure.

Infrastructure

The regulator published sector figures on 2 July: [about 47 million active SIM subscriptions and smartphone usage of 20 million devices, up from 18 million](#). The regulator's own quarterly report for the period to 30 September 2025 recorded 45.7 million active mobile subscriptions; both sets are compiled from licensees' submissions.

The ICT ministry [launched an updated national information security framework on 16 July](#), developed under the Uganda Digital Acceleration Project and setting minimum controls for government institutions, citing a 60% year-on-year rise in attacks including a UGX 62bn central-bank incident. The framework document itself is not published.

On 17 July the regulator opened work on a [national anti-piracy coordination framework](#) with broadcasters, three mobile operators, the revenue authority and the registration bureau. Legitimate pay-television subscriptions were given as about 800,000 in March 2026 against about 1.65 million in 2021. Dynamic address and name-resolution blocking is under exploration, and participants at the convening raised the dual use of blocking infrastructure built for piracy.

On 5 August the network operator with the largest published footprint released its 2025 sustainability report, recording for the year to 31 December 2025 [24.2 million subscribers, population coverage of 96.2% 3G, 88.6% 4G and 19% 5G, 27,037 km of fibre and 45% of network sites on solar or hydro](#). These are the company's own unaudited figures and the base holds no prior-year comparator.

Digital public infrastructure

Three payment arrangements were opened in the month, all private. A [licensed local-currency-in, stablecoin-out settlement corridor across four East African markets including Uganda](#) opened on 16 July with no volume or counterparty figure published. On 21 July [motor third-party insurance went on sale over a mobile-money channel](#) with a digital sticker issued online, framed by the insurance regulator as narrowing the protection gap; no premium, policy count or target was published. On 24 July a bank and a payments company [signed a memorandum on school-fees saving with payment-history-based financing, agent-network healthcare payments and digitised insurance](#). The signature date is unestablished, and nothing is on file about consent, retention or the legal basis for the credit-scoring layer.

The statistics bureau [commissioned 80 field data collectors on 4 August](#) for the ninth national household survey, deployed in 16 language-based teams after fifteen days' training, for twelve months of collection. No sample size, budget, funder or publication date was stated.

Governance and regulation

The data protection office's letter of 17 July confirmed compliance with the five orders in its [decision of 20 February 2026](#), which had required a data-protection impact assessment, an adequacy assessment, a legitimate-interests assessment and a Uganda-specific privacy notice. The decision imposed no fine and refused the complainant's prayers for cessation of intra-group sharing.

The regulator issued a [public notice on 7 July opening nationwide enforcement against unlicensed public Wi-Fi providers](#) under the Uganda Communications Act; no count of operators actioned has been published. On 23 July it reported [a five-year sentence for vandalising a mast in Kibaale District, where damage was valued at USh23.6 million, and a one-year sentence for a SIM-registration breach](#); the minister of state for ICT stated on 31 July that such attacks are treated as economic sabotage rather than as offences against private property.

Uganda was [elected to the African Telecommunications Union Administrative Council at Abuja on 24 July](#), one of 25 member states for a four-year term. At a regional central bankers' meeting in Kampala the same day, the chair called for a [harmonised East African framework for regulatory sandboxes covering artificial intelligence and digital finance](#); the meeting's signed communiqué records no such item.

On 30 July the transformation programme secretariat reported that its review of quarterly submissions under the fourth development plan [found gaps and inconsistencies in the data ministries and agencies submit through the national monitoring and evaluation system](#), naming no error rate and no remediation date. The same day, revised media guidelines issued through the [electronic court case-management system](#) required prior accreditation, barred devices from a courtroom and made live broadcasting a case-by-case grant.

Reporting of 29 July recorded that no work had begun on the [revenue authority's e-Tax2 procurement](#), whose technical evaluation the Appeals Tribunal set aside in October 2025 on a power-of-attorney defect; joint-venture staff have been on the authority's premises since January and none of 26 commercial banks would issue the performance guarantee gating the advance.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

On 30 July an external policy outlook [recorded Uganda as still developing an artificial-intelligence strategy](#) alongside a readiness assessment, sixteen months after the strategy was described as being in its final stages. On 2 August the minister of ICT told the Editors Guild annual general meeting in Jinja that the ministry is [developing a policy to regulate artificial intelligence and social media](#); no scope, drafting stage, responsible body, consultation route or timetable was given. Editors at the same meeting raised data-protection exposure from digitised newsroom operations.

Three innovation programmes were opened or closed. The ICT institute [launched the fourth and final cohort of a Japan-supported entrepreneurship programme on 22 July with 83 student innovators](#), publishing no cumulative startup, funding or job figure across the four batches. A [recurring fintech convening opened on 13 July](#). On 3 August the minister of state committed to [supporting commercialisation of innovations developed at the institute](#), with no budget, instrument, target or timeline.

Inclusion, capacity and finance

A tower company [remitted UGX 20.9 billion to the universal service fund](#), its statutory 2% of gross annual revenue, at a handover reported on 31 July. The regulator's executive director stated at the same event that half of that 2% goes to the Consolidated Fund and only half is retained to finance the fund, and put cumulative programme reach at laboratories in more than 1,000 public secondary schools. The period the payment covers was not published.

At a readiness inspection on 27 July, [six of nineteen planned one-stop service centres were recorded as operational](#), with three pilots funded through the Uganda Digital Acceleration Project and centre throughput made contingent on the fifth phase of the national backbone.

An [ICT hub for persons with disabilities was commissioned in Kasese](#), reported on 1 August, offering computer literacy, vocational skills and digital-empowerment programmes and open to the wider community. No commitment value was published, so the base carries no finance record for it.

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